

PET for Perfusion of the Heart

220.6.1 Links in PDF documents are not guaranteed to work. To follow a web link, please use the MCD Website.

Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

220.6.1

Manual Section Title

PET for Perfusion of the Heart

Version Number

2

Effective Date of this Version

04/03/2009

Implementation Date

10/30/2009

Description Information

Benefit Category

Diagnostic Tests (other)

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

1. Rubidium 82 (Effective March 14, 1995)

Effective for services performed on or after March 14, 1995, PET scans performed at rest or with pharmacological stress used for noninvasive imaging of the perfusion of the heart for the diagnosis and management of patients with known or suspected coronary artery disease using the FDA-approved radiopharmaceutical Rubidium 82 (Rb 82) are covered, provided the requirements below are met:

- The PET scan, whether at rest alone, or rest with stress, is performed in place of, but not in addition to, a single photon emission computed tomography (SPECT); or
- The PET scan, whether at rest alone or rest with stress, is used following a SPECT that was found to be inconclusive. In these cases, the PET scan must have been considered

necessary in order to determine what medical or surgical intervention is required to treat the patient. (For purposes of this requirement, an inconclusive test is a test(s) whose results are equivocal, technically uninterpretable, or discordant with a patient's other clinical data and must be documented in the beneficiary's file.)

- For any PET scan for which Medicare payment is claimed for dates of services prior to July 1, 2001, the claimant must submit additional specified information on the claim form (including proper codes and/or modifiers), to indicate the results of the PET scan. The claimant must also include information on whether the PET scan was performed after an inconclusive noninvasive cardiac test. The information submitted with respect to the previous noninvasive cardiac test must specify the type of test performed prior to the PET scan and whether it was inconclusive or unsatisfactory. These explanations are in the form of special G codes used for billing PET scans using Rb 82. Beginning July 1, 2001, claims should be submitted with the appropriate codes.

2. Ammonia N-13 (Effective October 1, 2003)

Effective for services performed on or after October 1, 2003, PET scans performed at rest or with pharmacological stress used for noninvasive imaging of the perfusion of the heart for the diagnosis and management of patients with known or suspected coronary artery disease using the FDA-approved radiopharmaceutical ammonia N-13 are covered, provided the requirements below are met:

- The PET scan, whether at rest alone, or rest with stress, is performed in place of, but not in addition to, a SPECT; or
- The PET scan, whether at rest alone or rest with stress, is used following a SPECT that was found to be inconclusive. In these cases, the PET scan must have been considered necessary in order to determine what medical or surgical intervention is required to treat the patient. (For purposes of this requirement, an inconclusive test is a test whose results are equivocal, technically uninterpretable, or discordant with a patient's other clinical data and must be documented in the beneficiary's file.)

(This NCD last reviewed March 2005.)

Cross Reference

See NCDs for [PET Scans](#)  (§220.6) and [SPECT](#)  (§220.12).

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 1817 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

[TN 1833 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

120

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/downloads/R120NCD.pdf> 

Revision History

02/2020 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received.

Previous NCD coding changes appear in ICD-10 quarterly updates that can be found at: <https://www.cms.gov/Medicare/Coverage/CoverageGenInfo/ICD10.html> , along with other CRs implementing new policy NCDs. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent quarterly releases and individual CRs as appropriate. No policy-related changes are included with the ICD-10 quarterly updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, longstanding NCD process. ([TN 2439](#) ) (CR11655)

05/2010 - Transmittal 108, dated October 16, 2009, is being rescinded and replaced with Transmittal 120. This transmittal restores language that was inadvertently removed from section 220.6. This transmittal also updates section 220.6.17, per Transmittal 110, Change Request 6753, dated December 18, 2009. All other information remains the same. ([TN 120](#) ) (CR 6632)

10/2009 - This change request rescinds and replaces Transmittal 106, dated September 18, 2009. The effective date has been changed to April 3, 2009 and the implementation date has been changed to October 30, 2009. Business Requirements (BR) 6632.6.1 and 6632.6.2 have been revised to clarify that they are subsets of BR 6632.6 and are specific to CED. All other information remains the same. ([TN 108](#) ) (CR 6632)

09/2009 - CMS is adopting a coverage framework that replaces the four-part diagnosis, staging, restaging and monitoring response to treatment categories with a two-part framework that differentiates FDG PET imaging used to inform the initial antitumor treatment strategy from other uses related to guiding subsequent antitumor treatment strategies after the completion of initial treatment. CMS is making this change for all NCDs that address coverage of FDG PET for all oncologic conditions. Effective date 04/06/2009. Implementation date 10/19/2009. ([TN 106](#) ) (CR 6632)

04/2005 - Removed text from [PET Scans NCD](#)  (§220.6) and created a separate NCD. Effective date 01/28/05. Implementation date 04/18/05. ([TN 31](#) ) (CR 3741)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Positron Emission Tomography \(N-13 Ammonia\) for Myocardial Perfusion \(CAG-00165N\)](#) 

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
PET for Perfusion of the Heart	2	04/03/2009 - N/A	You are here
PET for Perfusion of the Heart	1	01/28/2005 - 04/03/2009	View